SAM SURYA · DUBAI OFF-PLAN

FREE INVESTOR GUIDE · 2026

Dubai Off-Plan Investor Checklist

✅ 10 checks to make before you put a single dirham into an off-plan property in Dubai.

- 🏗️ Developer & project
- 🏦 Escrow protection
- 💰 True costs
- 📄 Contract & Oqood
- 🚪 Exit plan



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200+	600M+	50%
CLIENTS	IN SALES	REFERRALS

Is it safe?

Dubai protects off-plan buyers well. Make sure you're inside that protection.

01

The developer is registered with RERA

Open the official **Dubai REST** app (Dubai Land Department) and search the developer. Look at their completed projects and on-time handovers.

- [ ] Developer found on Dubai REST
- [ ] Track record of delivered projects checked

02

The exact project is registered, not just the developer

Every off-plan project has its own registration. Ask for the **project number** and search it on Dubai REST to see its status and construction progress.

- [ ] Project number verified on Dubai REST
- [ ] Construction progress (%) matches what you were told


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🔐 Protect your money

Where your money goes and who you deal with.

🏦

03

Your money goes into the project's escrow account

By law (**Law No. 8 of 2007**), off-plan payments go into a regulated escrow account for that project, not the developer's company account.

- ☐ Escrow bank & account on the payment instructions
- ☐ They match the project's escrow details on Dubai REST

⚠️ Never pay a deposit into a personal or general company account.

🪪

04

Your agent is licensed

Ask for the agent's **BRN** (Broker Registration Number) and verify it on Dubai REST.

- ☐ Agent BRN verified
- ☐ Agency and agent named on the paperwork

💰 Know the real cost

The price is not the whole story.

💰
05

You know the full cost, not just the price

DLD ~4%	Deposit 10–20%	Handover

Oqood is usually paid at booking (some launches cover or share it, so ask). At handover budget for DEWA, cooling (if any) and service charges. Get any agency fee in writing.

- [ ] Total cash needed at booking calculated

📱
TIP

Your #1 free tool: the Dubai REST app

Free on the App Store and Google Play, from the Dubai Land Department. Checks 1 to 4 take about **10 minutes** in the app. If a project or agent isn't there, walk away.

📈 Is it right for you?

It has to fit your cash flow and your contract.



06

The payment plan fits your cash flow

Write down every milestone: how much and when. Is it linked to dates or to construction progress? Is there a **post-handover** plan?

- [ ] Every instalment and date listed
- [ ] You can pay each one even if your plans change



07

The SPA (Sale & Purchase Agreement) is clear

Check unit number, size, floor plan, finishes, payment schedule, the **expected completion date** and what happens if handover is late.

- [ ] Unit, size and specs match the brochure
- [ ] Completion date and delay terms understood

⚖️ Lock in your rights

Registration and the fine print.

📜
08

Your purchase is registered (Oqood)

Oqood is the DLD's interim registration of your off-plan purchase. It protects your rights during construction and becomes your **title deed** at handover.

- [ ] Oqood certificate received

⚖️
09

You know the risk if you stop paying

If a buyer defaults, Dubai rules let the developer keep part of what was paid, depending on construction progress. Know the terms **before** you sign.

- [ ] Default and cancellation terms understood
- [ ] Resale rules known (when you can sell, NOC fee)

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🧭 Plan your way out

Know your exit before you commit.

🚪 10

Your exit plan makes sense

🏠 **Live** · 🔑 **Rent**: compare rents for similar ready units · 💸 **Sell**: check real resale prices on DLD data.

🌟 **Golden Visa:** property worth AED 2M+ can qualify for the 10-year UAE Golden Visa, off-plan included. Confirm current DLD conditions for your case.

- [ ] Exit plan chosen and numbers checked

🔐 RULE

The golden rule

No Dubai REST listing, no escrow account, no Oqood? **No deal.** A good project passes all 10 checks easily.

YOUR NEXT STEP

Want projects that already pass all 10 checks? 🎯

I work with Dubai's leading developers on **off-plan projects only**. Tell me your budget and the area you like, and I'll send you a shortlist with full payment plans, free.

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🏆 **Employee of the Year · Top Sales Performer**

General information as of November 2026, not legal or financial advice. Rules and fees can change; check with the DLD and the developer before you buy.

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